Switching SEO agencies without losing rankings: checklist (32 items)

Tick the items off on your own accounts. Take over the Google accounts before you send notice: after that, the agency has no reason to hurry. At the end of the contract: export the links, unlink Google Ads and close access.

Company and website _____ Agency _____

Date notice was sent _____ Contract ends (last day) _____

Google accounts

	NO.	ITEM	NOTES · WHO · WHEN
☐	1	Google Search Console: you are a verified owner, not just a user.	
☐	2	Google Analytics 4: you have the Administrator role on both the account and the property.	
☐	3	Google Tag Manager: you have account-level administrator rights and publish rights in the container.	
☐	4	Google Business Profile: you are the primary owner.	
☐	5	Google Ads: the account holds your billing details and your administrator access. Once the contract ends, unlink it from the agency's manager account.	
☐	6	Google Merchant Center (if you run an online store): you are an administrator.	
☐	7	The accounts were created with a company address, not a private address of an agency employee.	
☐	8	You have a written list of everyone with access to each account (you will remove them when the contract ends).	

Domain and website

	NO.	ITEM	NOTES · WHO · WHEN
☐	9	The domain is registered to your company and you have the login to the registrar's panel.	
☐	10	You have access to the hosting and to the DNS settings.	
☐	11	You have an administrator account in the website system (e.g. WordPress), not just an editor account.	
☐	12	You have a current backup of the website and the database.	
☐	13	If the agency built the website, its code is in your repository or you have a copy of it.	
☐	14	301 redirects from old URLs are documented and stay on the server.	
☐	15	The robots.txt and sitemap.xml files sit on your server and nobody changes them when the agency leaves.	

Content

	NO.	ITEM	NOTES · WHO · WHEN
☐	16	The contract transfers the economic copyrights to the texts, photos and graphics to you (check the fields of exploitation).	
☐	17	You have a list of the articles and subpages the agency prepared: URL and publication date.	
☐	18	You know which sites host the guest and sponsored articles and whether they stay up after the contract ends.	
☐	19	The texts, photos and graphics are on your server, not on the agency's.	
☐	20	You keep your own copy of the descriptions from your Google Business Profile and business directories.	

Links

	NO.	ITEM	NOTES · WHO · WHEN
☐	21	You have the full list of links acquired: linking page, target URL, date.	
☐	22	You know which links are permanent (articles, directories, partners) and which are rented from the agency's private network.	
☐	23	The contract does not provide for removing links after it ends.	
☐	24	You manually checked 10 random links from the list: they are still on the pages.	
☐	25	You have an export of links from Search Console (the "Links" report) dated the day before the cooperation ended.	
☐	26	You know whether the agency submitted a disavow file to Google, and you have a copy of it.	

Data and reports

	NO.	ITEM	NOTES · WHO · WHEN
☐	27	You have downloaded the monthly reports from the whole cooperation.	
☐	28	You have the list of target keywords with ranking history (an export from the agency's tool).	
☐	29	You have saved an export of Search Console data (16 months) and GA4 data.	
☐	30	You have the list of changes implemented and work planned.	
☐	31	You have documented the conversion setup in GA4 and Google Ads: which events count as inquiries.	
☐	32	After the contract ended, you removed the agency's access from all accounts and changed the passwords.	

Before you give notice: 5 things to check in the contract

Take the agency's contract and terms of service. These five points decide how much you will pay and what stays with you.

1. **Notice period.** How long it is and when it starts running: from the day the notice is delivered or from the end of the month. One day of delay can extend the contract by a whole period.
2. **Automatic renewal.** Whether a fixed-term contract renews on its own, and by what date you must give notice to prevent that.
3. **Exit fees.** Contractual penalties, an early termination fee, a clawback of the discount for a long commitment. Work out the cost before you decide.
4. **Content rights.** Whether the texts, photos and graphics pass to you and, if so, from when (often only after the last invoice is paid).
5. **Links after the contract ends.** Whether the links are yours or rented. Links from the agency's private network usually disappear with the contract, and with them part of your rankings.

Order of steps

	STEP	DATE
1	Take over the accounts before you send notice	
2	Download the data and reports	
3	Send notice in the form the contract requires	
4	Watch the website during the notice period	
5	Close the access when the contract ends	
6	Monitor results for 8 weeks	

Free review after your previous agency (30 min, online): we will go through this list on your accounts. Tel. +48 518 815 055 · kontakt@ai-seo-company.pl

Latest version of the list and answers to common questions: **www.ai-seo-company.pl/en/switching-seo-agency**

This is a practical list, not legal advice. Check the notice period and form in your own contract; the guide concerns agreements under Polish law.

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